



BOAT OWNER'S ANNUAL MAINTENANCE CALENDAR

BUILT FOR LOCAL BOATING SEASONS

A month-by-month guide for Ontario boat owners on Lake Simcoe, Georgian Bay, and the Toronto area. Built for a local season that runs roughly from the May long weekend through late October. Adjust dates a week or two based on your marina, your boat, and the spring weather.

SEASON

May - October

AREAS

Lake Simcoe | Georgian Bay | Toronto

SINCE

Serving boat owners since 2017

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Your maintenance year at a glance

Use this as the quick scan. The detailed monthly checklists follow.

May	Splash, shake-down, set the season up right	In-season
June	Get into the rhythm	In-season
July	Mid-season vigilance	In-season
August	Heavy-use month, watch for fatigue	In-season
September	Last full month of season, plan ahead	In-season
October	Wrap-up and haul-out	In-season
November	Settle in and inspect	Off-season
December	Quiet month	Off-season
January	Plan, book, and check the rules	Off-season
February	Quiet month, mid-winter check	Off-season
March	Spring is coming	Off-season
April	Pre-launch	Off-season

In-Season Maintenance

MAY THROUGH OCTOBER

05**May**

Splash, shake-down, set the season up right

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Splash, shake-down, set the season up right

- Remove shrink wrap if not already off. Inspect for tears or trapped moisture before disposal.
- Wash the hull and topsides before storage dust and road grime bake on in the sun.
- Check through-hull fittings and seacocks. Stiff or seized seacocks need attention fast.
- Inspect bilge pumps by adding water and confirming the pump cycles on and off cleanly.
- Test navigation lights, horn, and VHF radio. Replace burnt bulbs now.
- Check safety gear: PFDs, flares, fire extinguisher, and throw cushion.
- Top off fluids and run the engine at the dock. Listen and watch exhaust water flow.
- Inspect canvas and isinglass. Clean gently and treat small tears early.

OWNER'S NOTE

If your boat sat through a hard winter, the first hour of running is when problems show up. Do not head out for a long run on launch day.

In-Season Maintenance

MAY THROUGH OCTOBER

06

June

Get into the rhythm

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Get into the rhythm

- Book or complete the first detail of the season. A wash, polish, and wax helps protect gel coat.
- Check trim tabs for proper operation and hydraulic leaks.
- Inspect docking lines and fenders. Replace chafed or sun-damaged gear.
- Clean and protect vinyl seating. UV is hard on marine vinyl.
- Wipe down isinglass with dedicated cleaner; avoid ammonia glass cleaner.
- Check anchor and rode. Confirm the bitter end is attached to the boat.
- Run the boat at cruising speed for a real shake-down. Note vibration, overheating, or steering play.

In-Season Maintenance

MAY THROUGH OCTOBER

07**July**

Mid-season vigilance

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Mid-season vigilance

- Inspect below the waterline if you can. Bottom growth hurts fuel economy and top speed.
- Watch fuel and water filters. Mid-season is when contamination can show up.
- Check zincs. If more than half the zinc is gone, replace before the next outing.
- Inspect canvas snaps and zippers. A failing snap in July is a quick fix; a torn canvas later is a bigger repair.
- Top off engine oil between full changes if your usage is heavy.
- Clean the prop. A nicked or fouled prop costs fuel economy you can feel.

In-Season Maintenance

MAY THROUGH OCTOBER

08

August

Heavy-use month, watch for fatigue

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Heavy-use month, watch for fatigue

- Mid-season detail: wash, light polish, and re-wax. August sun is hard on gel coat.
- Inspect upholstery and canvas for sun fade or seam stress.
- Check engine belts for cracking or glazing.
- Inspect outdrive bellows if applicable. Cracked bellows let water where it should not go.
- Confirm safety gear is still in place and working.
- Start thinking about winterization booking. Shops fill up fast in late September and October.

OWNER'S NOTE

If you need new canvas, upholstery, or a major repair before next season, August is the month to start the conversation.

In-Season Maintenance

MAY THROUGH OCTOBER

09

September

Last full month of season, plan ahead

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Last full month of season, plan ahead

- Book winterization and haul-out. Confirm the date in writing.
- Book off-season work: canvas, upholstery, fiberglass repair, ceramic coating, or vinyl wrap.
- Inspect bottom paint. Note worn areas for repaint or touch-up at haul-out.
- Check paperwork: registration, insurance, and marina contract for next year if early-bird pricing applies.
- Consider a final detail. A clean boat stores better and launches better.

In-Season Maintenance

MAY THROUGH OCTOBER

10

October

Wrap-up and haul-out

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Wrap-up and haul-out

- Winterize the engine: stabilize fuel, fog cylinders if applicable, drain and flush cooling, change oil and filter.
- Drain water systems: fresh water tank, water heater, head, and A/C if equipped. Add non-toxic antifreeze where needed.
- Remove electronics that can be removed and store them somewhere temperature-stable.
- Strip cushions, canvas, fenders, lines, and anything that holds moisture.
- Confirm shrink wrap or canvas cover is tight with proper ventilation.
- Take photos before storage for insurance and spring comparison.
- Pay deposits on any off-season work you have booked.

Off-Season Maintenance

NOVEMBER THROUGH APRIL

11

November

Settle in and inspect

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Settle in and inspect

- Visit the boat once wrapped. Confirm the wrap is tight and ventilation is open.
- Document seasonal issues while they are fresh: stress cracks, soft spots, worn cushions, or leaks.
- Review the season: fuel, hours, what broke, and what surprised you.
- Renew or update insurance for the off-season storage period.

Off-Season Maintenance

NOVEMBER THROUGH APRIL

12

December

Quiet month

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Quiet month

- Confirm storage premises are secure: locks intact, cover supported, snow load not stressing the wrap.
- Start the off-season project list: what needs fixing, replacing, or upgrading before May?
- Begin parts research for DIY projects. Marine parts can have long winter lead times.

Off-Season Maintenance

NOVEMBER THROUGH APRIL

01

January

Plan, book, and check the rules

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Plan, book, and check the rules

- Toronto International Boat Show runs in mid-to-late January at the Enercare Centre. Worth a walk through for accessories, product previews, and manufacturer conversations.
- Book your spring detail or commissioning. Slots fill fast for the May launch window.
- Confirm off-season work in progress: canvas, upholstery, fiberglass, repower, or wrap.
- Check your Pleasure Craft Licence (PCL) expiry. As of December 31, 2025, new, transferred, and renewed PCLs are valid for 5 years. Older licences without an expiry date were assigned one based on the original issue date.
- Order parts you will want for spring projects.

Off-Season Maintenance

NOVEMBER THROUGH APRIL

02

February

Quiet month, mid-winter check

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Quiet month, mid-winter check

- Mid-winter wrap inspection. After heavy snow, check that nothing shifted and ventilation is clear.
- Review last year's fuel, maintenance, and storage costs for budgeting.
- Finalize off-season projects you want done before May. Shops booking now are the ones that still have time.

Off-Season Maintenance

NOVEMBER THROUGH APRIL

03

March

Spring is coming

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Spring is coming

- Confirm spring launch date with the marina.
- Confirm spring detail or commissioning appointment.
- Start the de-winterization checklist: fluids, filters, and gear removed in October.
- Order consumables: oil, filters, fresh fuel, zincs, polish, and wax. If last season's fuel was treated with stabilizer, plan to drain or burn it off and refill fresh.
- Inspect trailer if applicable: tires, bearings, lights, and brakes.

Off-Season Maintenance

NOVEMBER THROUGH APRIL

04**April**

Pre-launch

THIS MONTH'S FOCUS: Pre-launch

- Remove shrink wrap on a dry day and inspect everything that was hidden under it.
- Pre-launch wash, polish, and wax if you did not book a spring detail.
- Replace zincs.
- Check battery charge, terminals, and hold-down. Replace if 4+ years old.
- Reinstall electronics, cushions, and canvas, or schedule canvas install after launch.
- Inspect through-hulls, seacocks, and hoses before the boat goes in.
- Confirm insurance is active and pay outstanding marina, club, or service balances.

OWNER'S NOTE

Some people splash the last weekend of April. Most wait until early May. If water temperature is still in single digits, there is no rush.



Honest notes and service support

Use the calendar as a starting point, then adjust it to your boat and marina.

This calendar is a starting point, not a rulebook. Your boat, your marina, and your habits will shape the specifics. A trailered fishing boat has a different rhythm than a 35-foot cruiser slipped at Krates. Use the months as anchors and adjust to your situation.

The biggest costs in boat ownership come from things deferred. A small canvas tear becomes a torn enclosure. A worn zinc becomes a corroded outdrive. A skipped winterization becomes a cracked block. The work that prevents those is rarely glamorous, and it is almost always cheaper than the repair.

You do not have to do all of this yourself. Most boat owners do the things they enjoy and hire out the things they do not. The smart move is knowing what needs doing, when, and deciding which jobs are yours and which are someone else's. That is what this calendar is for.

WHEN YOU WOULD RATHER HAND IT OFF

Toronto Yacht Club has been serving boat owners since 2017 with detailing, canvas and upholstery, fiberglass and gelcoat repair, vinyl wrap, winterization, spring launch services, bottom paint, SeaDek flooring, and mobile service across the Toronto area.

Detailing | Canvas & Upholstery | Fiberglass & Gelcoat Repair | Vinyl Wrap
Winterization | Spring Launch | Bottom Paint | SeaDek Flooring | Mobile Service

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